Thamesmead TIMES

Issue 51 Date 30th February 1999

WIN A Morning with Caesar the Geezer at Millennium Radio

See page 6

THE PEOPLES' PRIORITY

More Spending on Security for Play Areas and Homes

Over £400,000 is being invested in new security and CCTV systems in Thamesmead over the next few months. Childrens play areas and residential estates are the top priorities.

Launching these initiatives, Thamesmead Town Chief Executive, Gregory Lomax, said:

"Last year we organised the largest residents' survey ever. The response was phenomenal. We received thousands of replies.

Top of people's priorities was increased spending on improved security and the installation of extra CCTV cameras.

Although crime and violence rates are very low in Thamesmead, we understand people's fears and want to make the town even safer. We have excellent co-operation with the police and our own security staff are first rate, but we are always striving to improve.

Now we are meeting peoples' needs and delivering our promises.

In addition to smaller upgrading schemes in places like Cole Close and Austin Close in Waterfield, we also aim to complete three major projects by early summer.

Each scheme will bring real benefits to Thamesmead.

For the first time we will be installing cameras in five playareas. Children shouldn't be at risk.

Parents wanted this initiative. So did we. The play areas are:

- Glimpsing Green
- Aspen Way
- Abbey Way
- Crossways Park
- Broadwater Green

Elsewhere we will be targeting residential areas.

In Disraeli Close we will be spending over £90,000 installing wide vision door entry cameras that will protect stairways and enable residents to see who is seeking entry. The cameras will be fitted in high security casing and positioned to avoid vandalism or other damage. They will record non-stop and give Security Control at Harrow Manor Way a 24 hour continuous record of any incident.

The third project is even larger. Over a quarter of a million pounds will be spent upgrading door entry systems in eight blocks along Wolvercote Road and Kale Road.

Nearly 400 families will benefit from these improvements as older entry systems are replaced by new state of the art audio/visual systems which can track a caller's movements from the initial contact, through the internal lobby and finally into the lift.



Play areas such as Abbey Way (above), will benefit from the installation of the new CCTV cameras.

We've all heard the stories. Of a caller arriving at the door with several others. Of callers being admitted into blocks and then apparently vanishing. Under the new system residents will be able to see exactly what is happening and to check on a caller's movements from the safety of their own homes.

And remember, if anyone anywhere has any doubts about a caller – don't hesitate to call us on Freephone 0800 83 84 81. Security will investigate immediately. It's always better to be safe than sorry afterwards.

At the same time as installing these new systems we are also upgrading our central control station, fitting powerful consoles which can use a network of infra red zoom cameras to remotely monitor known troublespots.

Increasingly the installation of these systems enables us to see our resources effectively, hotspotting security staff to where they are most needed when they are needed.

We are also investigating other possible schemes, including the introduction of portable camera systems.

I share residents concerns about security. Thamesmead Town is listening. Together we can beat crime."

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Thamesmead TIMES

Editorial and Advertising enquiries to The Editor.
If readers, individuals or organisations have any interesting local news and stories that would interest our readers please send them to:

The Editor
Thamesmead Times
Harrow Manor Way
Thamesmead South
London SE2 9XH.

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DIRECTORS ON DUTY AT THAMESMEAD TOWN OFFICES

DIRECTOR	WEDNESDAY	SATURDAY
Tony Moon	24 February 1999	27 February 1999
Albert Devereux	3 March 1999	6 March 1999
Tony Cox	10 March 1999	–
Charan Gill	–	13 March 1999
Valerie Killman	17 March 1999	20 March 1999
Michael Ofori	24 March 1999	27 March 1999
Tony Moon	31 March 1999	EASTER SATURDAY – OFFICES CLOSED

Thamesmead Helps Hospice with Free Labo

Thamesmead Town had donated over £1,000 worth of labour to the Mayors charity to help build a walkway at a local hospice.

Last year's Mayor of Bexley, Cllr Rita Sams, set up a charity appeal to raise funds to build a walkway and seating veranda in the grounds of the Bexley and Greenwich Cottage Hospice.

Thamesmead Landscape Ltd, carried out labour and landscaping to the value of £1,000, to ensure the area was safely cleared and cut up bef commenced.

The hospice provides free care for the t Greenwich and Bexley and they hope th viewing platform will provide a perfe patients, families and staff to relax, have to spend some time alone.

Jim Bennett, Appeals Director, said, Town kindly provided all the clearance expect the walkway to be completed by really will be a truly peaceful and serene patients and visitors".



ABBEY GETS A HA

Elected Directors Albert Devereux and Val Killman were on hand to present Abbey Primary School with a bumper gift from Thamesmead Town's Community Development Fund last month.

The grant will help pay for new book teaching aids.

Abbey is the sixth local school to be company grants. The others were Hav the Jubilee School, St Margaret Clith Primary and Bishop John Robinson. Primary brought the combined total almost £12,000.



TALK ABOUT

Val Killman has been the Director for Lesnes since last June. Before then, in her own words, 'I just used to catch the train from Abbey Wood in the mornings, go to work, come home, shut the door, and look after my family.'

She never voted in elections, never bothered very much with what happened in the town, never knew who was Chairman or Chief Executive.

So what changed?

The answer is children. Eleven of them. Her grandchildren.

"We moved to Thamesmead from Catford 27 years ago. We used to live on a main road. Thamesmead was so different, so quiet and clean, so much safer to bring up our four children. But right from the beginning there wasn't much for youngsters to do. The old GLC used to make lots of promises about swimming pools and other top notch facilities, but it never came to anything.

When I started to think about what my grandchildren needed to Thamesmead I decided to get involved. To do more. And the more I've seen, the more interested I've become.

Children have always played an important part in my life. I raised four of my own. For the last eleven years we've fostered teenagers for Greenwich Council, helping them towards independence. We've got a couple of teenage girls living with us now.

Over the years I suppose we've fostered between 15 and 20. Mainly for a couple of years at a time.

It's very demanding work, sometimes even very stressful. It's not as if you can clock off at 5 o'clock and go home to let your hair down after a bad day at the office. But it's also a tremendous challenge and when things work out well, it's terrifically satisfying. We've stayed in touch with some youngsters for years. They are part of our family, part of our life.

Not every child is lucky enough to be loved or really wanted. Everyone needs an understanding family, someone to care for them, often just to be there.

Bringing up children, especially teenagers, is two way. We teach them, sometimes they can teach us.

They face lots of dangers. I'd like more facilities for teenagers on Thamesmead, like safe places they can go to if their mums go out to work, places they can do their homework and places where they can be themselves without getting into trouble.



Val Killman

I'd like to see a new community hall on the Lesnes and ideally a cinema and bowling complex in the town. Thamesmead has changed so much in recent years. We've become a real community. It's time the tiny minority who are always knocking everything that happens in Thamesmead grew up. Elected Directors put in lots of time. No one gets paid, we are all volunteers. We do it because we want to, because we care about where we live, because we want to make it better.

Although I'm a member of the Company's Commercial and Audit Committees my real interests are in Community Development and charitable work. I help out at the Credit Union – I used to work in accounts – and I wish we could do something about the fact that one half of the town, the Bexley end, has to pay more to use the Leisure Centre than the other half which lives in Greenwich. Sometimes it feels very unfair.

I've never regretted coming to Thamesmead. Sure I've got some gripes – I can't stand people who dump their rubbish under trees and act to selfishly. But we have many friends here and I can never see myself leaving.

Double Tops for Town

Thamesmead Town has recently won two Bexley Business and Community awards for its services to the community.

The awards were presented to the company at a special ceremony at Bexley civic offices and were given by the Bexley Education Business Partnership in recognition of the company's support for local schools and colleges.

The Partnership exists to promote links between local schools and businesses.

Thamesmead's first award was given in the Community Action category where the company's support for a special mural project involving Southlake School was widely praised.

Co-ordinated by Thamesmead Town's landscape planner, Irene George, the project enabled pupils at Southlake to design the artwork for murals which were subsequently painted at the Tavy Pools play area and on the hoardings used to screen building work during the recent conversion of the old Safeway building in Joyce Dawson Way.

The second award acknowledged the company's long standing support for Thamesmead Community College's annual presentation evening. Thamesmead Town has sponsored this event for the last eight years.

Accepting the awards on behalf of the Company elected Director and Vice-Chairman of Thamesmead Town, Tony Cox said:

"The evening was a chance to celebrate the links between the company and local schools. We are very grateful to Southlake School and to Thamesmead Community College for nominating us. These awards mean a great deal to all those who are working to improve links between schools and businesses in Thamesmead."



Mayor of Bexley, Cllr Chris Ball, (centre) presenting the awards to elected director Tony Cox on behalf of Southlake School and Thamesmead Community College.

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Thumbs Up For Residents

Once again Thamesmead has been voted one of the best housing managers in London.

Latest returns show tenant satisfaction with housing repairs now averaging 97% slightly up on last year's similarly impressive results.

Thamesmead Town currently handles around 28,000 repair requests a year with 94% completed within the target time. Although most requests are for small repairs ranging from dripping taps to squeaking doors, larger jobs include replacing faulty heating cylinders and installing new polycarbonate safety windows.

This year Thamesmead Town will spend nearly three-quarters of a million pounds dealing with reactive repair requests and a total of £4 million on repairs and maintenance in the town itself.

More than 60 tradesmen are working in the town every day, employed by either one of the four general contractors or with one of the three specialist firms used by the company or as part of Thamesmead Town's own Technical Support Team. For emergency repairs the Housing Department provides a 24 hour, 365 day service.

For the last two years tenants have been asked to complete a questionnaire after a repair request. A freepost reply envelope is included.

This is how Thamesmead Town scored on the six key questions in January.

Were you satisfied with the way in which your repair request was dealt with when you reported it?	Yes 97%
Was the repair carried out satisfactory?	Yes 94%
Was the repair carried out by the date quoted?	Yes 94%
If there was a delay were you advised beforehand or did the workmen leave a card?	Yes 97%
Was your property left in a clean and tidy condition?	Yes 99%
Were the workmen polite and courteous?	Yes 99%

Every reply is individually read and checked by Housing Administrator, Linda Harris.

"We want everyone to reply. We have just redesigned the questionnaire to extract more information from tenants. If anything goes wrong or if the service is not up to scratch, we want to know about it. Feedback is essential. We can't put things right if we don't know what may have gone wrong!

And if people lose the survey form or if they would rather make an appointment to see someone, they can always ring our Repairs desk Freephone on 088-83-84-81. We want to hear from tenants.

The questionnaires are often useful in other ways. Sometimes it points us to other jobs that need doing. Some tenants also use the questionnaire to raise unrelated issues. We've had requests for information about local council services. Occasionally we also have pleas for help, perhaps from a lonely pensioner or from a depressed single mum. Whatever the request we do our best to assist either by referring such requests to other departments or by contacting the relevant local authority."

Thamesmead

Repairs Desk Freephone

Dial 0800-83-84-81

Our repairs team await your call



Take Another Look at Abbey Wood & Thamesmead

John Austin, MP, officially launched the Abbey Wood & Thamesmead Partnership at its new offices at 7 Tavy Bridge, to mark the start of a large regeneration programme for the area.

The partnership has won £5.675 million of Government funding from the Single Regeneration Budget (SRB) to help transform the Abbey Wood & Thamesmead area through a range of activities.

These activities will include:

- Enhancing the education, skills and employment prospects of local people.
- Supporting new and existing businesses and improve the competitiveness of the local economy.
- Protecting and improving the local environment.
- Promoting initiatives of benefit to ethnic minorities.
- Tackling crime and improve community safety.
- Enhancing the health and the quality of life of local people.

The programme is a partnership between Thamesmead Town, Greenwich Council and Bexley Council working with a range of local organisations including Trust Thamesmead, voluntary service councils, local councils for racial equality, the Police, Groundwork and SOLOTEC.

Work has already begun on the project and all work will involve one or more of the following three themes:

- Stake in the future through reducing social exclusion and creating employment and training opportunities.
- New generation of young people through improving education attainment and reducing youth unemployment.
- Changing perceptions by improving the image of the area and reducing crime.

John Austin, MP, said, "This programme will bring enormous benefits to the area. Once the projects get going, local people will really notice some big changes. The partnership is tackling the big issues of concern to the community. By facing up to the challenges of unemployment, affordable childcare and leisure facilities, the local community should be able to face the future with confidence".

THAMESMEAD ADVICE DAY

In a continuing move towards offering excellent housing advice services, Thamesmead Housing Management held their third arrears advice day last month.

Housing staff were on hand to talk over any enquiries relating to rent accounts, or to give advice on housing issues. Supplies of leaflets on housing and welfare benefit were made available and a representative from the Citizens Advice Bureau was also present to give general money advice.

Area Housing Manager, Jackie Andrews said, "The three days we have held so far have all been a success, and we have plans to hold more days in the future. We have had a high turnout of residents, all who have benefited from the service."

TOWN CENTRE SUCCESSES

More new shops are bei planned for the Town cent following the successful letting of s of the seven units in the form Safeway development in Joy Dawson Way.

'Beds and Pine' report encouraging trading a 'Tilemates', a new specialist floor and wall tiling sh – ideal for DIY enthusiasts – is currently being fitt out for an early opening.

Other new units in the scheme include the relocati of the 'Front Page' newsagency.

Plans for an Indian restaurant in the parade are al well advanced and there is considerable interest the last remaining unit.

'The success of this scheme is very encouraging', s Thamesmead Town commercial business manag David Novi. 'The shop vacated by The Front Page h been let and we are now drawing up plans to provi an additional three or four units in the Town centr The success of the Safeways store and rece openings by Aldi and McDonalds have given t town a real boost. Last year's repaving has also add to its attractions along with free parking and oth amenities.'

Mr Novi also disclosed that talks are also taking pla with several hoteliers who have approached t Town looking for a possible site.

MORE HELP FOR THE ELDERLY

More than 400 personal alarms have now been distributed free of charge to elderly residents by Thamesmead Town.

The alarms could be life saving if someone was injured in the home or suffered a heart attack and was unable to reach a phone or to summon help.

The alarms emitt a powerful 130+db siren which can be heard up to a radius of up to half a mile.

13 local groups have been offered this service by Thamesmead Town. Among the first to receive supplies were members of the Arthritis Group which meets at the Jubilee Centre, the Tavy Bridge Senior Citizens club, the Limestone Bingo club and supporters of the Arnott Club.

Recent beneficiaries include members of the Evenlode Pop in Parlour, Broadwater Village Hall, and the Limestone Pensioners' Afternoon club.

More alarms will be distributed by Thamesme Town's Community Development Department stocks become available.

Reaction to the initiative has been extreme positive with local doctors and others welcomi the scheme. It is also extremely popular amo residents. And at the Evenlode Pop in Parlour jok fly with members quizzing each other – have y been alarmed yet?!



Elected director Michael Ofori distributes the personal attack alarms at the Limestone Club.



Mrs Kempton at the Tavy Bridge Senior Citizens Club.



Elected director, Keeley Savill, (right), with Mrs Harle the Arnott Clubroom.

The Front Page

THAMESMEAD'S GOOD NEWSAGENT AND MUCH MORE

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COME IN OUT OF THE COLD

There was a raw, biting wind blowing through Thamesmead on 29 January; the kind of weather that gets you heading quick-smart for the comfort of home at the end of the day.

So it was a relief when the front door of 126 Binsey Walk was opened by the cheery Mike Gage, Comfort 2000 Liaison Officer, and we were shown into the nicely decorated, welcoming warmth of the comfort 2000 showflat.

Thamesmead Times along with Natasha Swainsbury, who is Thamesmead Town's housing officer for Southmere, were Mike's very last customers before the showflat was dismantled and re-let and Mike himself moved on to a new job. "You're the last of about a thousand people who have visited the flat since it opened in September last year." Mike beamed. "Come and have a look around and tell me what you think about it."

Well what did we think?

Nice. Very nice indeed. Slim, sleek radiators. Neat, thin, unobtrusive pipework that had been painted the same colour as the walls behind so they were all-but invisible. The high quality Potterton boiler was so trim and compact it tucked nicely into a kitchen cupboard. And everything had been finished just beautifully. Right down to the last lick of paint.

Curiously enough, for a showflat that was there to demonstrate the benefits of integrated central heating, the one thing you really didn't notice was the temperature. But on reflection, that makes sense, doesn't it? You wouldn't want to feel too hot or too cold: just comfortable.

"Each radiator has its own thermostatic control that adjusts easily to give you the temperature you want to each individual room," said Mike. "For example, you might want a nice snug sitting room, but a cooler bedroom. Or if you're cooking up a storm, with three saucepans on the go and a roast in the oven, you probably won't want the kitchen radiator going full blast as well. You can turn it off, or simply turn it down."

So this is heat that is under control

Everyone who visited the showflat was asked what they most wanted from their domestic heating and hot water system. In almost all cases, the answer was warmth that you can control. "The great thing about Comfort 2000 is, you can have the warmth where you like and when you like," said Natasha Swainsbury. "There are chilly days in late Spring or early summer when you might want a bit of heating on. Equally, you can get nice warm days in Autumn when you don't need added heating."

In addition to the individually controlled radiators, the system's timing device is easily programmed to turn the heating on and off automatically as you require. "You can time it to be on when you're at home and off when you're at work. It's the way to save money," said Natasha.

What opinions have the visitors had?

Close on a thousand residents have stepped over the threshold of the Binsey Walk showflat. There have been days organised exclusively for people with special needs: deaf and blind people, for example. There have also been days organised exclusively for Thamesmead's ethnic community, with translators provided. So what did they all make of it?

"For the most part, responses have been very positive, and some people liked it so much they even wanted to move in," said Mike. At this point he pulls out a pile of papers. "Everyone who visited was asked to fill in a questionnaire about what they thought. Take a look at them."

We flick through them at random. "Very modern radiators look nice, with a neat boiler," noted Mrs Kempton. "I like the idea of controlling my own heat in any room," wrote Miss Housley. Mrs Lambe said, "It's just great. Much cleaner and easier to control." And just one word from Mr and Mrs Facey: "Fantastic!" they wrote.

One of Natasha's tenants, Mr John Sewell, who also lives in Binsey Walk, has already had the Comfort 2000 central heating system installed in his flat. "He absolutely loves it. He thinks it's such an improvement over the old system," says Natasha.

Has nobody had doubts about it?

It would be unnatural if some people hadn't expressed doubts over the project and we asked Mike what the most commonly-voiced concerns were. "Some people are worried that the layout of their homes is not the same as the showflat. So radiators will have to be positioned differently. Or they don't want the boiler where we have put it at Binsey Walk. I tell them that as far as possible, we shall try to be flexible. The installation engineers will do their utmost to adapt the system to individual requirements."

"They are also concerned that we may not treat their homes as if they were our own. They're worried about mess, or making good afterwards. I reassure them that damage will be minimal and will be repaired afterwards."

Natasha, who obviously cares a great deal about the tenants in her area joins in: "I've seen the way some landlords work and I can tell you that Thamesmead's repair service is second to none. Besides, the two new liaison officers will oversee everything and make sure all is running smoothly."

What Happens Next?

Following tenders, a contract for the £14.64 million project has been awarded to Tilbury (City) Limited. The contract covers installation, scheduled to begin in April and for a subsequent 10-year maintenance programme.

After testing the market, Thamesmead's Financial Director has received an indication offer package from HVB Real Estate Capita partnership with the Nationwide Buildin work is in hand to concert this into a firm in place the security necessary to suppor

Some 250 residents have attended C consultation meetings, held in Decembe February. And a display showing exa installation is planned for different type types of dwelling will be on show in Town's reception area. Call in and see it.

Before work begins on individual ho area, several empty properties will be ta converted. Studios; on, two and three bec as well as maisonettes and town houses system installed. Local residents will be a how Comfort 2000 will work in their own

Power to the People

The final work goes to outgoing liaison Gage, as he locks up the showflat in Binse last time. "It's been a great place to come day. All the comforts of home, you migh most part, the people I've met have been and enthusiastic about Comfort 2000".

"It's a project I have honestly believed i is modern, clean and very efficient. But al the heating controls in the hands of the use it. And I'm a great believer in that."



The bathroom.



Comfort 2000 liaison officers, Adel Picton Mike Gage.







Come and See Caesar the Geezer for yourself!

We are offering you a once in a lifetime chance to spend a morning on live radio with one of the nations liveliest radio presenters.

What do you have to do? It's easy, just answer the three questions below and you will be in with a chance to join Caesar the Geezer and the Breakfast Bunch, for a breakfast at Millennium radio station that you'll never forget!

A. On what frequency do you find Caesar the Geezer and the Breakfast Bunch?
B. From what time can you tune in to hear the breakfast show?
C. Name one of the other radio stations that Caesar the Geezer has performed on in the past?

Our lucky winner will also appear in the Thamesmead Times. So don't delay, our closing date for entries is Friday 5 March 1999.

Please send entries to:
Caesar the Geezer Competition
Thamesmead Times, Harrow Manor Way
Thamesmead South, London SE2 9XH

Competi Winne

Many congratulatio Homewood of Man winning the Valentines for a romantic valentine Swallow Hotel in Bexle Homewood and husban free glass of champagne, 3-course meal and finally

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VOLUNTEERS WANTED

If you have Saturday evenings free, and would like to help young people with a learning disability, a social project based in Erith would like to hear from you.

Do you have an interest in gardening?
A day centre at Bostal Heath is seeking a gardener to help them design and build their own small garden.

Would you like to help the blind or partially sighted people?
A range of volunteers are needed to help with home visits, social activities and clubs.

Could you help spread the work for a local group?
Assistance is needed to deliver leaflets to public places such as Doctors surgeries, respite groups, etc.

Help is also needed for fundraising events.

For further information on any of the above vacancies, please contact the Volunteer Bureau Manager, Kevin Wiles on

0181 304 0911

Greenwich Chinese Community School

1999/2000 Academic year starts in September.

Minimum age for enrolment is 4 years old.

The school will have Cantonese classes, Mandarin classes, English classes and Mathematics Supplementary classes.

School opens every Sunday, including morning and afternoon classes.

Different activities will be available every Saturday.

Telephone number for registration is

0181-858 2410

(5pm-7pm Mrs. Chan).

School venue: Meridian School, Old Woolwich Road, London SE10 9NY. (Very near Maze Hill BR station, Bus: 108, 177, 180, 199, 286, 386)

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JESUS IS LORD

'Extra' help from Santa

Over 150 people attended TRUST Thamesmead's Extraordinary General Meeting, on 29 January, to see four local community groups receive cash awards.

The meeting held at the Thamesmead Leisure Centre, was attended by the Mayor of Greenwich, Cllr Don Austin and the Deputy Mayors escort, Cllr Mike French.

Ted Clarriage presented cheques to the Young Foundation pre-school, the 5th Abbey Wood Brownies, the Waterway's Children Centre and Neutral Ground.

The money was donated from the Father Christmas Fund, and will be used by all groups to help buy essential equipment.

A quiz night rounded off an enjoyable evening. The wooden Spoon was awarded to Age Concern and the brainy bunch of the night were the 'Fast Acting Lockets'!



Trust Thamesmead give out the awards to various local community groups.



The Mayor of Greenwich, Cllr Don Austin, and the Deputy Mayor's escort, Cllr Mike French put their heads together at the quiz night.

Canon Chris Byers licence by the Woolwich at a servic Paul's Church on 2 Fe will give him a ne contract to work in T with the clergy te chairman of Trust Tha



Canon Chris Byers with his lice

THE REDEEMED CHRISTIAN CHURCH OF GOD

Heronsgate Dental Centre

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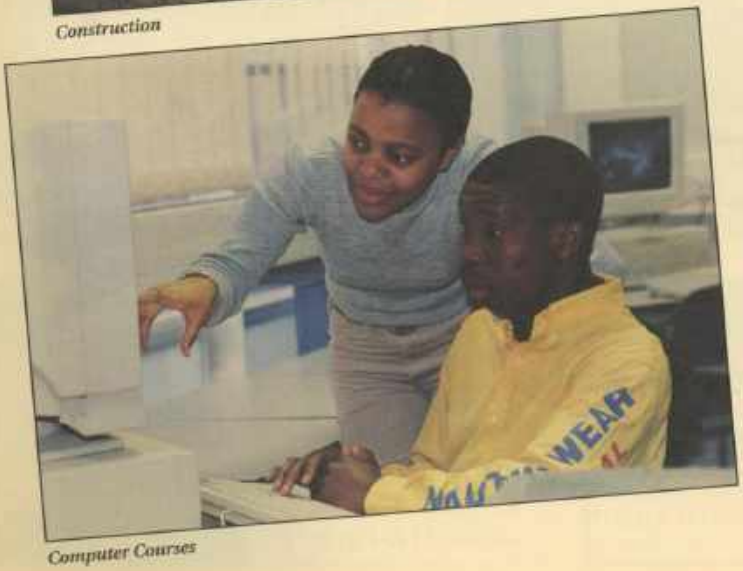
Thamesmead Takes T



Thamesmead Town Regeneration Project Officer, Janice Piotrowski and her assistant, Sharron Feetham.



Construction



Computer Courses

No-one is too old, too young, too inexperienced or been unemployed too long to qualify for Thamesmead's Employment Initiative: the trail-blazing project that is getting local people off the unemployment register and into jobs.

Working in partnership with organisations such as Inbiz, the Employment Service and the Prince's Trust, the Employment Initiative's principal role is to help local unemployed residents train for new skills or improve their existing skills, in order to find work.

It is a policy which clearly works. According to Julian Martin, Thamesmead's Director of Economic and Community Regeneration, and in charge of the Initiative, more than 350 people have been helped with training since the project began just over a year ago. Of those who completed their training, some 56% have found jobs.

Giving help where it's needed

The Employment Initiative is administered by Regeneration Project Officer Janice Piotrowski and Assistant, Sharron Feetham. Between them, they have exactly the right mix of background experience, empathy and enthusiasm to make the scheme a success.

Janice Piotrowski previously worked with the Employment Service, but realised there was clearly-defined limits to the ways in which she could help people. She said: "At Thamesmead we can be much more flexible and imaginative in the kind of help we give. We can target someone's needs very accurately and offer exactly the right solution."

There is certainly nothing rigid about the way the Initiative operates. To begin with, it is available to anyone who has been out of work for more than four weeks, whether they be school-leavers, older, long-term unemployed, or parents returning to work after bringing up the family.

Similarly, there are no restrictions to the kind of training that can be undertaken. "If someone is enthusiastic about a job that really interests them, and can prove there is a need for people in that field of work, we'll help them train for it," says Janice.

That help could begin with finding just the right course – and the Employment Initiative team personally check out the credentials of all the training providers. Thamesmead may then pay for the course as well as providing financial help with any required books or with travel expenses. It all depends on individual needs.

Equipment and start-up costs

The Thamesmead Employment Initiative also helps people who want to start their own business. And once again, the degree of assistance vanes from person to person. Thamesmead resident Lorraine Adams for example, had been unemployed for seven years and came to the Employment Initiative for help with training. During the initial interview it became evident that Lorraine had definite artistic abilities, but she had never realised her skills were marketable.

Thamesmead sent her on a painting and decorating course, paying her travel expenses and course fees. She gained an NVQ Level 3. To gain practical help and advice on setting up her business, Thamesmead put her in touch with a team of professional business advisors. And finally, to get her enterprise up and running, Thamesmead paid for her driving lessons.

It has to be a two-way street, however, Lorraine had played her part by working hard and showing a great determination to succeed.

Practical help

Other people are being helped in different ways. Some might receive travel assistance to attend a job interview, or to pay their fare to work until they receive that all-important first salary. Practical help like this can be vitally important to those living on benefit.

There are also jobs where the employee is required to provide his or her own basic equipment as a condition of employment. Stephen Bowles was offered such a job on a two-year contract but couldn't afford the requisite ladders, brushes and paints. Thamesmead supplied them.

When someone has completed a training course they are by no means abandoned. The Employment Initiative team invites them back and gives

he Initiative On Jobs

p looking for jobs and preparing them for interviews. Together, they go ough the local Job Centres and check out the Situations Vacant pages of wspapers and specialist magazines. If they wish, they can receive free ion on how to put together a good CV and how to present themselves at erviews. Janice Piotrowski says: "Our role is to make people more ployable. We know that when someone finally sits down for a job erview, we couldn't have prepared them better."

Fitting the skills to the jobs

amesmead's Employment Initiative doesn't stop with training and paring local residents for work. It also goes some way towards ensuring jobs are there to begin with.

or example, when new businesses come into the area (such as Wimpy o are currently building 500 new homes in Thamesmead) as part of the il Thamesmead ensures that one quarter of the workforce must come m local labour.

There is a great deal of new development in the area" says Janice trowski. "Over the next five years more than 2,500 new homes will be built Thamesmead. Couple this with other projects and there will be around 00 jobs available in the construction industry alone. We find out from v employers exactly what skills they will require so we can start training ople accordingly."

The job opportunities available in the near future will be for people ned in leisure and tourism, catering, construction, administration, HGV ving and retail skills. But if someone persuades us there's a need in the rketplace for a different skill, we'll train them for it."

Thamesmead's Comfort 2000 will also bring jobs to the area. The contractors charge of the project will be hiring a percentage of their staff from local our, with jobs beginning in April. The employment contracts will be for two l a half years initially, with the possibility of a one-year extension.

owards the end of February, Thamesmead will be holding pre-interviews Comfort 2000 carpenters, plumbers mates, painters and decorators, ourers and one site manager. For those who might need their skills aging up to scratch, speed development courses are available.

hamesmead offers an added incentive to employers who take local dents with new or upgraded skills onto their staff. They provide a £75 per k wage subsidy for the first six months of the employment, with a view to t employment becoming permanent.

Future Initiatives

reat deal has been achieved in this last year, but until some magic, way day in the future when Thamesmead achieves full employment, re is still much to be done.

onstantly looking for further training opportunities, the Employment iative has recently negotiated two new courses with Woolwich ytechnic. From April onwards, courses in Tourism and Leisure will be ilable at the Polytechnic every Wednesday afternoon. And for those who h to learn or improve their Information Technology skills, IT courses will eld every Thursday afternoon.

om mid-February onwards, the Woolwich Arsenal Job Centre will be g into the Thamesmead Town offices once a month, between 9am and n. These days will be open to anyone who wants to know about all the l, up-to-date job opportunities. Those who can't get there in person can phone to find out where the jobs are.

n 1st and 2nd March, Thamesmead Town will host a number of courses ed at providing local unemployed people with specialist skills. There will a two-day course on Customer Care; four half-day courses on First Aid, senting St. John's Ambulance Brigade Certificates at the end of each rse; a two and a half-day Health and Safety course and two one-day rses on Basic Food and Hygiene.

he next project in the pipeline is to visit local Junior Schools and talk to ents of children who are moving on to the next level of education. It is and this time that parents start thinking about returning to work and will need help from Thamesmead in preparing for it.

lso underway is a local poster campaign and a door-to-door leaflet drop rming residents of all the help, advice and training available through amesmead's Employment Initiative. The message it sends comes over d and clear. If you are unemployed and want to work, this is a service that give you real, practical help in securing a job.

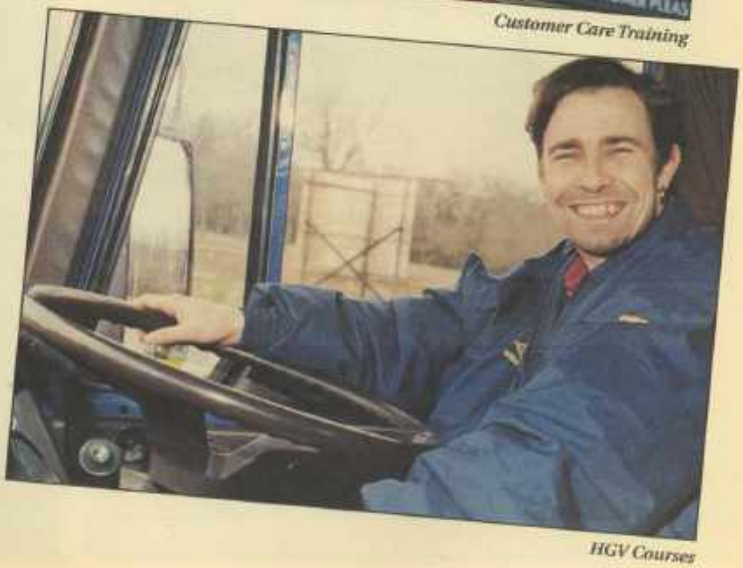
what are you waiting for? Ring Janice Piotrowski (0181-320 3463) or rron Feetham (0181-320 3465) and make an appointment to meet them.



Care Worker Training



Customer Care Training



HGV Courses

NO HIDING PLACE FOR DRUG DEALERS

A local resident has been evicted after her live-in partner was jailed for three and a half years for drug dealing.

The conviction followed a successful police raid and search last year when undercover officers found £2,000 of crack cocaine plus a number of mobile phones used to set up heroin deals at the property.

The arrested man had previous convictions for drug offences and was on bail at the time of his arrest for possession of amphetamines and other banned substances. He was also involved with other well-known criminals in the area.

Speaking after the conviction Thamesmead Town Housing Director, Tony Cotter, insisted that the welfare of the wider community must always come first.

"The dealer was living in the town with one of our tenants. He was dealing from phones found at the property. He had thousands of pounds of drugs secreted on his body when the police arrested him. Neighbours reported there were lots of callers to the house.

We provided valuable assistance to the police during this investigation and we wouldn't hesitate to do so again.

We have a special responsibility to protect young people. We already have a policy of not housing convicted drug offenders. Now we will evict those who are involved in such criminal activities. We can't just leave it to parents, or schools and the police. Protecting the community has to be a community effort."

Other anti drug initiatives run in the town include:

- Sound City drugs free disco nights, now attracting over 200 youngsters every month.
- The Roving Play Scheme which offers fun and constructive activities for youngsters aged 8 and upwards.
- Grants and subsidies from Thamesmead Town to local anti-drugs groups such as the Greenwich and Bexley Drugs Agency.
- Free distribution of drug awareness information to local primary school children.



- Anti-drugs poster competitions and funding for theatre groups to visit local primary schools with drugs awareness schemes.
- And from April, a new Youth Awareness Programme for 16-25 year olds aimed at simultaneously helping young people to keep off drugs while developing their personal and job seeking skills.

What An Xperience

Over 1,000 people attended the BE'Xperience Day that was held on a sunny Saturday in February to help celebrate the borough's recycling success and to give younger residents the chance to learn about their environment.

The environmental experience day included various activities ranging from a bumpy Land Rover ride across Footscray Meadows, traditional wood clearing in Bexley Park wood and indoor fun with The Mayor, Cllr Chris Ball, who read environmental stories to Bexley's younger residents. Southlake School staged an arts workshop where pupils handcrafted masks that were then worn during their environmental display.

The day ended with an array of activities at the Civic Offices and with further environmental entertainment from local schools and youth groups. Thamesmead Music Centre made it's first public appearance playing Recycling Rage and Suburban Sprawl and students from the Liz Burvill Dance Centre, Bexley, entertained the guests with an environmental fashion show with a difference.

Finally, Lucy Anderson, aged 10 from Southlake School had something very important to say, that actually affects us all. Lucy told the Thamesmead Times, "I hope all the people who chop down trees stop because it's killing nature. They should *think* about what they are doing because otherwise, what's going to be left for my children when I grow up"?

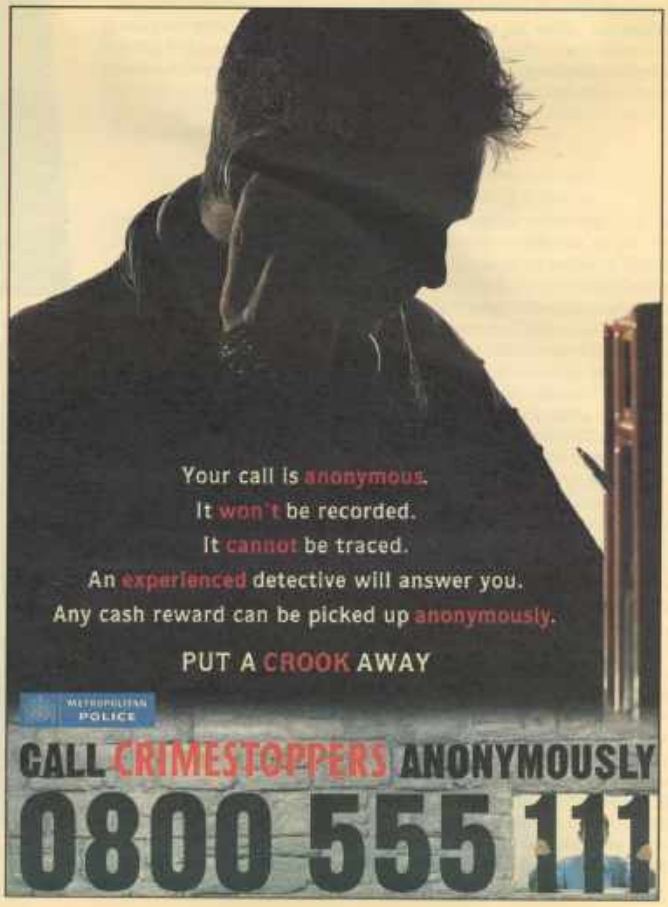
We couldn't have put it better ourselves!



Thamesmead Music Centre with The Mayor, Cllr Chris Ball.



Environmentally educated Lucy Anderson from Southlake School.



Cannon and Ball Takes Thamesmead Over The Edge

Over 30 local residents, community groups and Thamesmead Town staff were roped into abseiling 100 feet down the Holiday Inn at Brent Cross, Hendon, in aid of 'Help a London Child'.

After some expert, on the spot tuition, it was time for the crew, led by the main organisers, Denyse Cannon and Jo Ball, to brace themselves for the dizzy descent.

It all proved to be plain sailing for the daredevils who raised over £1,500.00 for the charity. Commenting on the day, Denyse Cannon said, "The whole team was so nervous and our legs turned to jelly! But it was well worth it because we were really pleased with the amount of money raised for such a worthy charity. We are very grateful to everyone who took part, but special thanks to Baldie at Thamesmead Town."



Natasha Swainsbury, takes it all in her stride to Help a London Child.



"All in a good days work", the Thamesmead crew raised over £1,500.00.

Calling all football mad girls aged 7-12 years

Soccer coaching for girls only groups

At Woolwich Polytechnic Boys School, Thamesmead

And Lessness Heath School, Erith

Saturdays between 10am and 11am

Arsenal prizes, medals and certificates at the end of the course

Boys and girls welcome at all soccer school venues

For further information call:

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Chinese School Celebrates Year of the Rabbit

According to the old saying of the Year of the Rabbit, "the year ahead will bring you some good times and some difficult times, you will need courage to stand with it".

The Greenwich Chinese Community School celebrated the coming of the Year of the Rabbit at a special spring festival at the Greenwich Cinema.

Honourable guests, including The Mayor of Greenwich, Cllr Don Austen, who opened the celebration, Nick Raynsford MP for Greenwich and Woolwich and Li Wang Rong, the Councillor of the Chinese Embassy, attended the occasion.

Guests were treated to a feast of dancing from pupils and a top-level dancer from Mainland China. This was followed by the showing of a traditional Chinese film, "Home Again", which gave everyone an insight into Chinese culture and family life.

Head teacher, Josephine Chan, said, "The day was lovely and all our guests had a wonderful time. We would like to thank those who funded the day, our volunteers, parents pupils, the press and the nice friends. We wish everyone good health and good success in the Year of the Rabbit".



Greenwich Chinese Community School and Yan-Huang Cultural & Arts Association

SOUND CITY

Drug and Alcohol Free Zone

March 5
March Madness

April 9

TOP DJs Over 14s

7.30 - 11.15

Entry £3.00 (member) £5.00 (non-member)

The Management reserves the right to refuse entry

Retired Postman Sets Example

An 81 year old retired postman, from Goldcrest Close, is helping to boost literacy among school children by recycling used Christmas cards.

For the past 4 years, Mr Jim Ryan has encouraged friends and neighbours to support him in the Post Office Christmas card recycling scheme. He has even set up his own collection point.



Jim is all smiles as he delivers his Christmas cards.

Jim delivered his cards to Abbey Wood Post Office, and was presented with a gift for all his hard work and dedication. Once recycled, the cards will be made into homework reading diaries, which will help parents and carers work with children at home to improve their literacy skills.

ARE YOU A POTENTIAL FOSTER CARER?

The Mayor of Bexley, Cllr Chris Ball, joined the Bexley Community Fostering team to unveil a new recruitment programme aimed at potential foster carers in the Bexley Borough.

In their biggest campaign ever, the Bexley Community Fostering team hope to persuade people that they too could be a suitable carer for a child who needs to spend some time away from their home.

Speaking at the launch, the Mayor, Cllr Ball said, "As a teacher and Mayor, it is very heartening to know that something positive is being done to give every child a happy home life."

Maureen Barnes, Senior Social Worker, said, "Many people do not realise just how qualified they are to join us as foster carers. We can provide any training potential carers may need and are able to offer a realistic financial allowance to help cover the cost of taking in a child."

Furthermore, the team are to be one of the first in the country to launch a new National Vocational Qualification (NVQ) level 3 course in Foster Care, and they are already recruiting for courses which will start in late 1999. Based at the Howbury Centre, the course will run at parent and carer friendly times, 10am-3pm.

If you feel you could lend a hand to the children of Bexley and would like to find out more about becoming a foster carer, then please call 0800 783 7699.

MILLENNIUM 106.8FM SCHEDULE

MONDAY TO FRIDAY

0600	Caesar the Geezer and The Breakfast Bunch
1000	Jon Lucas
1300	Delroy Haynes inc. Mill Lunch
1600	Paul Stuch Drive Time
2000	Starsound
2300	(Friday Only) Nicky G
0000	(Friday Only) MDFM

SATURDAY

0530	Vietnamese Programme
0600	Gavin Christian
0700	Dave Lockwood
1000	Paul Stuch
1400	Charlton Live
1730	Ray Bradshaw Soul Session
2000	Starsound
2300	Nicky G
0000	MDFM

SUNDAY

0600	Wendy Saunders
0900	Julie Goodwin
1300	Delroy Haynes
1600	Caesar The Geezer and Co.
1900	Charlton Live
2030	Starsound
2300	Nicky G
0000	MDFM



Caesar the Geezer live and exclusive on Millennium Radio 106.8FM

Happy 8th Birthday to Danny Alford
Lots of love from Paulene, Fred, Johnlee, Jasper and Christopher

To a wonderful Mum
Have a very Happy Birthday on the 12 March.
All our love, Caroline and Tom.

Happy 16th Birthday
to Dave Gibbs for the 9th March.
Lots of love, Vicki
xxxxx

All at Thamesmead Town would like to wish
Diane Giacomelli
all the very best for the future

Happy 8th Birthday to Danny Alford
Lots of love from Mum, Dad, Timmy and Splash

Happy 21st Birthday to Bonny Taylor on the 15th March.
Lots of love Mum, Dad, Dean and Matthew

THAMESMEAD
PEOPLE • PLACES • THINGS



Free of Charge
Announcements

Do you have an announcement that you would like printed? Whether it is a birthday, anniversary or a death, we would welcome your contribution. The advertisement will be free of charge. It would be appreciated if you could keep your announcement to no more than 35 words and sorry – we cannot print any photographs.
Please send your announcement to:



The Editor, Announcements
Thamesmead Times, Harrow Manor Way
Thamesmead South, London SE2 9XH

YOUR STARS

Capricorn (21 December – 19 January)

A feeling of independence comes over you this month and you will decide there is something you need to achieve for yourself, and by yourself. The experience will make you much stronger and able to cope with any problems life chooses to throw at you. Use your new resolve to help a friend out of a sticky situation. Lucky day 10 March.

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

A lapse in communication leaves you looking like the villain. You know you were not to blame, and have the proof at hand to get yourself off the hook. In this situation, you need to take a selfish attitude to make sure the truth comes to light. Shielding the guilty party will do you no favours at all. Lucky day 28 February.

Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

A piece of shockingly good news will knock you for six, and you will spend the month on cloud nine. Though it will seem that everyone gets swept along with your good fortune, a certain someone may feel left out, and may start to resent you. Make sure you are on the ball at all times, as failing to notice this problem will create unnecessary future arguments. Lucky day 5 March.

Aries (21 March – 20 April)

A newfound friend will signal the start of a new beginning for you this month. They will lead you down a road of self discovery and help you unleash all the feelings you have held back for so long. It's an unselfish friendship that will stand the test of time and which will teach you the true meaning of give and take. Lucky day 9 March.

Taurus (21 April – 20 May)

Your obvious lack of resources seems to be the cold water that gets poured over your every wish you have for the future. However, if you put up with some short term discomfort, and put a cap on your out-goings then your dreams will start to be more believable, not to mention achievable. Lucky day 24 February.

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

A mysterious hand delivered letter will become an obsession and you will have an unwavering desire to find out who sent it and why. Accept the flattery, and then forget the whole affair, you are reading much more into it than there actually is. Enjoy a weekend of indulgence before your healthy eating begins. Lucky day 16 March.

Cancer (21 June – 20 July)

A recent decision about your chosen career path will prove to be the correct one. The only thing left to do is make sure you dedicate lots of time to your work, so you can go right to the top! A small windfall is heading your way so make sure you spend it wisely – don't blow it all in one go, otherwise you will be back to square one. Lucky day 20 March.

Leo (21 July – 21 August)

You exhibit much pride in your possessions. Understandably, your blood boils when others show no respect or care with the things you have worked so hard for. It's only going to take one more smashed glass to make you explode. Try and explain to the culprit how you are feeling before it gets to this stage. Lucky day 26 February.

Virgo (22 August – 22 September)

A flirtation at work could get out of hand, which is fine if it's what you want, but dangerous otherwise. Make a stand early or someone could get hurt. You feel run down after stressful times at work, so get checked out by your doctor, and take some time off work to recharge your batteries. A well-earned rest is just what you need. Lucky day 3 February.

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your sharing and caring nature will mean that you always pick up plenty of friends on your journey through life. The only problem you do have is that you do not have enough time to keep in touch with them all. It sounds harsh, but you really must prioritise and spend the time with those who you value most, as you can't always please everyone. Lucky day 23 February.

Scorpio (23 October – 22 November)

Your plan to match-make two friends, who you believe are the perfect couple, is destined for failure. Leaving them to their own devices is by far the best course of action, as interference from you will only mean they will isolate you from their lives. If they want or need your input, rest assured that they will ask for it. Lucky day 15 March.

Sagittarius (23 November – 20 December)

Someone at work has a personality that simply grates on your nerves. You get annoyed with yourself as you let this person push you around. If you want that promotion you have so long desired, you must stand up for yourself. This will stop the bully and ensure that you get the recognition which you so richly deserve. Lucky day 7 March.

What's On

13 February until 13 March – Children's Art Civic Society at the New Gallery, Hall Place, Bourne Road, Bexley. Contact: 01322 526574.

27 February until 27 June – The River Cray from source to sea. A history and natural history collaboration from Bromley and Bexley museums, at the Bexley Museum, Hall Place, Bourne Road, Bexley. Contact: 01322 526574.

Tuesday 23 February at 8 pm – Sidcup Literacy and Scientific Society present 'The Queens Heralds', a talk by Mr J Bedells, at the Emmanuel Church Hall, Hadlow Road, Sidcup. Annual subscription costs £7. For non-members the cost is £1 per lecture.

Thursday 25 February at 7.30 pm – "Off to the Pictures", a local studies talk by Tony Moss, at Hall Place, Bourne Road, Bexley. Tickets priced £2.50 are available, in advance, from Hall Place. Contact: 01322 526574.

Friday 26 February 2.30 pm-5.00 pm – Creative writing workshop with Eric Treppass at Welling Library, Bellegrove Road, Welling. Tickets priced £2.50 are available in advance from the library. Contact: 0181-303 2788.

Saturday 27 February 7.30 pm-11.00 pm – Bexley Voluntary Service Council minibus fundraising appeal Barn Dance with live band, at Crayford Town Hall. Tickets are priced at £6, call the ticket hotline on 0181-304 0911 extension 24.

Saturday 27 February 9.30 am-12.30 pm – Booksale at Blackfen Library, Cedar Avenue, Blackfen. Contact: 0181-300 3010.

Saturday 27 February 10 am-1 pm and 2.15 pm-4.30 pm – Bumper Booksale at Slade Green Library, Bridge Road, Slade Green. Contact: 01322 335027.

March 2, March 14, April 13 and April 25 – Visits to the Crossness Engines at the Crossness Works, Belvedere Road, Abbey Wood. The visits are by appointment only. Tickets are priced at £2 for adults and £1.50 for concessions. Contact: 0181-311 3711 on Tuesdays and Sundays, between 9 am and 4 pm only.

Until 26 March – Pupil Referral Unit art display at the Minstrels Gallery, Hall Place, Bourne Road, Bexley. Contact: 01322 526574.

Until 27 March – Photographic display by Mr C Bland at Welling Library, Bellegrove Road, Welling. Contact: 0181-303 2788.

From 9 February – Defending the Caveman at the Apollo Theatre, Shaftesbury Ave, London W1. Former Big Breakfast Comedian, Mark Little, makes his West End acting debut in this witty and wise new comedy on differences between men and women. Tickets priced between £5 and £25. Contact: 0171-494 5070.

17 March until 21 March – The BBC Good Food Show at Olympia's Grand Hall, London. See the experts from BBC's top cooking programmes whip up creative dishes and give inspiring advice. Tickets are priced between £10 and £14.50. Discounts apply for group bookings of 10 or more. Ticket hotline number: 0870 730 7303.

Spring 1999 – A variety of events are happening at the Science Museum this summer. All events are included in the general admission price (£6.50 for adults and £3.50 for concessions). To obtain a full programme of events, please contact: 0181-938 8000.

Turning Back the Clock: A Glimpse into Thamesmead's Past

Valerie Wigfall, the author of 'Thamesmead Back to the Future', will be giving an illustrated talk at Thamesmead (Newacres) Library at 7.30pm on Wednesday 10 March 1999.

Valerie Wigfall is a sociologist who, after spending a year researching into Thamesmead's history, is particularly well qualified to speak on this subject. In her book, she traces the development of Thamesmead over its thirty year life span, seen through the eyes of the people who have shaped it. Her talk will be illustrated with slides.

Tickets, which include refreshments, cost £2.50 and are available from Thamesmead (Newacres) Library, Binsey Walk, telephone 0181-310 9944.

EMERGENCY TELEPHONE NUMBERS

Aids Helpline	0800 567123
Alcohol Abuse	0171 352 3001
Bereavement	0181 332 7227
Bexley Council	0181 303 7777
Childline	0800 1111
Crimestoppers	0800 555111
Drugs Helpline	0171 603 8654
D.S.S.	0181 301 8300
Gas	0800 111999
Gay Switchboard	0171 837 7324
Thamesmead Town	0181 310 1500
Greenwich Council	0181 310 8888
Greenwich Hospital	0181 858 8141
L.E.B.	0181 298 9898
London Transport	0171 222 1234
N.S.P.C.A.	0800 800 500
Rape Crisis Centre	0171 837 1600
Relate	01322 275691
R.S.P.C.A.	0990 555999
Thames Water	0645 200 800
Samaritans	0345 909090
Debtline	0645 500511
Free Furniture Collection Greenwich Special Collection Line	0181 316 5946
Bexley – (Respond)	0181 310 8808

NATIONAL MINIMUM WAGE

citizens advice bureau

On 1 April 1999, the National Minimum Wage will come into force. The gross rate of pay for workers over the age of 22 will be £3.60 per hour. Workers aged between 18 and 21 will be paid a minimum of £3.00 per hour, this will rise to £3.20 per hour from June 2000. There is no minimum wage for workers under 18 years.

The term workers include employees, some self-employed and independent contractors, agency workers, home workers and crown employees. Agricultural workers will still be covered by the Agricultural Wages Board which will set a rate no lower than the National Minimum Wage.

Some workers are excluded, namely share fisherman, volunteers who are paid expenses only, prisoners who are working according to prison rules and members of the armed forces.

From 1 November 1998 workers who will qualify for the minimum wage are protected from dismissal or victimisation if their employer tries to dismiss or victimise them because they qualify.

The Secretary of State will set up enforcement officers to enforce the minimum wage. If they suspect an employer of not paying the minimum wage they will serve him/her with an enforcement order.

It will be an offence to refuse to pay the minimum wage or to keep inadequate records. The maximum fine is £5,000 per offence.

It should be remembered that this is minimum wage and employers are free to pay more.

The above information is provided by Erith Citizens Advice Bureau, who run a surgery at New Acres Library on Mondays from 10.30am to 12 midday and money advice sessions 3pm to 4pm and on Wednesday between 9.30am to 11am. They can also be contacted on 01322 340481.

Books on Wheels for Bexley's Housebound

If you are a book lover, who is housebound and physically unable to get to a library, then read on as the Bexley Housebound Books on Wheels service may be just what you need!

The 200 regular users are able to loan a selection of fiction and non-fiction books as well as talking books. Volunteers from the Woman's Royal Voluntary Service, deliver the books to the readers home every month. The service is free to all housebound borough residents, and it is funded by Bexley Council and is free to all housebound borough residents.

If you would like more information about the Housebound Books on Wheels service, call Juliet Oliver on 01322 525704.

THAMESMEAD VOLUNTARY CLOTHING PROJECT

TVCP

1 Tavy Bridge, Thamesmead, SE2 9UG

BOWLED OVER BY THE VIRGINIANS!

Lewisham bowl turned into the Wild West last month, when the Virginian Western Show Team held a 12-hour sponsored bowl to help raise money for a local charity.

To reach their target of £1,000 for the Charlton Park Group of the Riding for the Disabled Association, the Showteam organised the sponsored bowl and a Country and Western Evening.

The "Virginians", who include several Thamesmead residents, dress up in authentic Western Clothing and put on shows to help raise money for local charities. And whether it is a mock jail break, bank robbery or sponsored bowl they make an impression wherever they go!

Ray Bowden, Secretary of the Showteam said, "I would like to thank everyone who helped us with these events. It was a lot of hard work, but it's worth it when we know it will help a good cause. We have collected over £800 already, but we expect that when all the money has been rounded up we will well exceed our £1,000 target."



The Virginian Western Showteam.



Ian Walkling (Taz) bowls 'em over!

MARAFUN IS BACK

If you are fairly fit, like getting wet and dirty and would like to raise lots of money for a local good cause then Marafun on Sunday 16 March 1999, is definitely the event for you.

The whole day will centre round an obstacle course, straddling the River Cray, at Footscray Meadows in Sidcup. The not so fit and active will have plenty to keep them entertained as there will be live music, stalls and side shows.

Anyone who decides to face the challenge of the obstacle course will pay a modest entry fee, and will be encouraged to gain sponsorship. All the monies raised will go towards Marafuns chosen charity for 1999, the Greenwich and Bexley College Hospice, which is situated in Abbey Wood. The hospice looks after the terminally ill of Greenwich and Bexley, and as it provides all its services free of charge, it relies heavily on the community to support its activities.

Marafun, in past years has raised thousands of pounds for local charities, and it is hoped the community will rally together to give bumper support for this years worthy cause. If you want to help – and think you have the stamina to complete the obstacle course then call the Marafun Hotline today.

The event is organised through the Sidcup Rotary, Sidcup Rotaract, Bexley and Sidcup Lions and Sidcup Round Table.

If you would like further information, an application form for the obstacle course, or are a local charity who would like to hire a pitch, then please call the hotline on 0181-304 6010.

Kill Your Speed and Cut Down Deaths on the Road

At 35 mph, you are twice as likely to kill someone than you are at 30 mph. This is why Bexley Council is supporting the Government's latest Kill Your Speed Campaign, which aims to cut the numbers of deaths on the road caused by speeding.

The council has sent posters and leaflets to libraries, schools and information centres in the borough. Twenty buses from the Bexleyheath bus garage will also carry the kill your speed message.

The biggest cause of road deaths and injuries is driving too fast for the conditions, though few people will think that they drive irresponsibly or too fast.

The problem is, dangerous speed is much slower than we think. Most people associate it with haring along motorways. The reality is surprising. Two thirds of accidents in which people die or are hurt, happen on roads with a speed limit of 30 mph or less.

At times we all drive too fast. When you get behind the wheel, remember the terrible consequences for thousands of families every year. Tomorrow's casualties haven't happened yet. There's still time to prevent them. Everyone who drives can play a part. KILL YOUR SPEED.

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For more information about the Project please contact:
Steve Hall on 0181 303 777 Ext, 3883
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Charlton Win at The Valley • London Towers Back to Winning Ways

London Towers Round Up

The Towers faced a disappointment in their uni-ball trophy quarter final game, losing 61-62 to the Leicester Riders on 27 January. Though the Towers started the stronger of the two sides, the Riders fought back to level the score at 51-51 by the end of the third period. The closely fought battle finished in favour of the Riders, thanks to a winning free throw from the ex Towers player Karl Brown. Leicester will now face their East Midlands rivals Derby Storm in the next stage.

The Towers were back in league action at the home of the Newcastle Eagles, where they suffered their second defeat in two days. The Towers' new signing, Randy Duck made his debut.

An early 10-3 lead for the Eagles, left the Towers on the back foot, and by the end of the first quarter Newcastle had outscored the Towers 24-9. Lino Frattin's men made a fight of it in the second and third quarters, but to no avail. A run of seven unanswered points put the home team ahead by eleven points, with less than one minute remaining. For the Towers, who were behind from start to finish, 79-61 was a disappointing result.

The run of two defeats was put to an end when the Towers faced ITT L&B Worthing Bears on 3 February. Despite the Bears early lead, the Towers had their noses ahead for most of the game. They enjoyed a three-point lead from the first quarter, which was then extended as they opened up the second period with seven unanswered points. The only other sizeable run of the game came down the stretch, as the Towers extended their 87-81 lead with the last seven unanswered points.

A second successive victory followed in the clash with Milton Keynes Lyons on 6 February. Randy Duck had a fine home debut, though it was almost spoiled by a gritty Lions side.

A Dwayne Morton three pointer on the Buzzer put the Towers 19-11 up going into the second. With neither team able to build up a sizeable streak, the gap was still 8 by the end of the third. The Towers were leading 60-51 midway through the final period, but a 7-1 run from the Lions, saw them close the gap to 61-60 with just 2:00 to go. Crucial baskets from Malcolm Leak and Martin Henlan then opened the lead to 65-60. A last gasp comeback from the Lions brought them within 1 point of levelling the score with just seconds left. But the Towers had victory in sight. A Leak free throw and a Henlan put back secured the 68-64 victory for the Towers, to take them to 6th in the Budweiser league, on the same points as 5th place Derby Storm.

The Towers climb up the table continued after a win against the Peugeot Birmingham Bullets on 13 February took them to joint 4th position. Danny Lewis masterminded a second half recovery to give the Towers a 79-74 win, that was screened live on television.

The key to the narrow victory was stopping the scoring potency of Bullets' captain, Nigel Lloyd. He bagged five first half three pointers among his 20 points, as the Bullets went 39-34 ahead at the half time interval. However, the Towers managed to keep him quiet in the second half and he failed to score in the final two quarters. In the third period, 12 unanswered points from the Towers turned the tables and while the Bullets rallied to lead briefly, the Towers were always in control down the stretch.



Ray Schultz on a move towards the basket against the Leicester Riders.

HOULLIER IN HARD LUCK STORY

Charlton Athletic 1
Liverpool 0

Liverpool boss Gerard Houllier hit out at referee Mike Reed for sending-off Jamie Carragher as Charlton took full advantage to claim their second win in six days by scoring from the ensuing dead ball. Steve Brown's quick free-kick down the right flank and John Robinson's far-post cross found the visitors' defence in disarray and Keith Jones smashed home the loose ball for his first-ever Premiership goal. It was enough to secure the Addicks' first victory over the Merseysiders since Boxing Day 1959.

The Frenchman foamed: "I am angry, because the referee's decision changed the face of the game. He was good in the first half – nobody noticed him. But then suddenly he made three bookings in three minutes and his decision to send off Carragher was wrong. I would like to know why he did it, without even having shown him a yellow card. Carragher tells me he did nothing and I'm told the video doesn't show anything either. The referee won't see anyone, but he has made a decision which changed the result.

"We knew it would be difficult here from the fact that Manchester United won in the last minute and Arsenal on a penalty. But I think we could have got at least one point. This is the second time we have suffered with this referee sending someone off and without us knowing why. He penalised us twice, because he didn't allow us to reposition after the sending off before Charlton got the goal. What's the point of us working all week if you have got a referee like that. I think it was a bit dubious today.

"Apart from that, Charlton deserved their win. It would have been very close, 1-0 either way, but I would have liked them to have won in another way. With our players coming back from international duty in midweek I knew we would lose once we went down to ten men."

Addicks boss Alan Curbishley commented: "We worked very hard this week on tactics and everything went according to plan. People will talk about the sending-off, but you have to contain Liverpool as a newly promoted side. We did it to Manchester United and to Arsenal, but if you don't you end up losing 8-1 or 6-2. You have to give them the respect they deserve and that's what we did. Our aim was to stay with them and that's what happened. We had a few half-chances, which could have been converted, before the sending-off. I'm delighted for the players, because we needed to put two wins together and that is exactly what we have done.

"What happened off the pitch this week was irrelevant to us, but the club perhaps deserves some credit for the people involved being caught. If it is going on throughout football, as some think, then perhaps we've helped put a stop to it. Perhaps it means people will be more vigilant.

"On the football side we've had four consecutive home games, which wasn't ideal, and were perhaps unlucky with the disallowed goal against Newcastle and the last-minute winner by United against us. On top of the run we've had that would have finished some people off, but the fans and the players have been up for it all season here. We've managed to get those two wins on the spin which is what we have needed and now we've given ourselves a chance.

"Keith has been a bit frustrated, but I changed the side and left young Paul Konchesky out. He was very disappointed, but I brought Keith in to do a job in the middle of the park. They have got three England internationals there and we needed someone, but Keith did exactly what we wanted and for him to get the goal as well is the icing on the cake. He's waited a long time to play in the Premiership and he's relishing every moment of it."

Curbishley said that he had not seen the controversial incident: "We had just made the substitution and Neil, who came off, was a bit unhappy. Something went on there, so I missed it. The players are saying that Carragher caught Pringle. I don't know how intentional it was, but the referee was right there."

Fishing in the South East

by John Perkins

Firstly this month, I would like t briefly mention last month's topic namely livebaiting. I do attend a lot meetings of various angling governi bodies, and I do put forward the re views of fishermen. I therefore need have your opinions as soon as possibl As I said last month, the Governme Review Committee is discussing th subject.

Happily, the rivers are returning to form now that t rain has let up considerably. Usually chub, at this time the year, feed like there is no tomorrow, as do brea However, as long as the water temperatures is not too lo good sport can be had fishing for roach. You would do w to follow the methods by Bob Nudd, outlined in t Angling Press. He uses casters extensively, but they must kept fresh. You can do this by storing them in a seal container in the fridge. Open them every day, for an ho to give them some air. Also, when you buy them, look o for the grey ones, as they are dead. He also mentions a fa that I had not appreciated. The lightly coloured one which tend to be softer, are much favoured by per However, the main quarry is roach – although all speci like casters. I would also say when fishing for roach, loo feed a little hemp.

Of course, the other great target fish is pike. On one our lakes, a few weeks ago a dozen pike were landed. couple of eighteen pounders topped the list.

If anyone has any queries or problems, or needs a information about fishing in the South East, please do n hesitate to call me. After all, the sport is just as good, if n better than it is in the Midlands – even though this is rar reported by the media. Furthermore, anyone who wou like to fish in Kent, please contact me on 01622 202686 an application form.

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